Part of SPRINGER NATURE

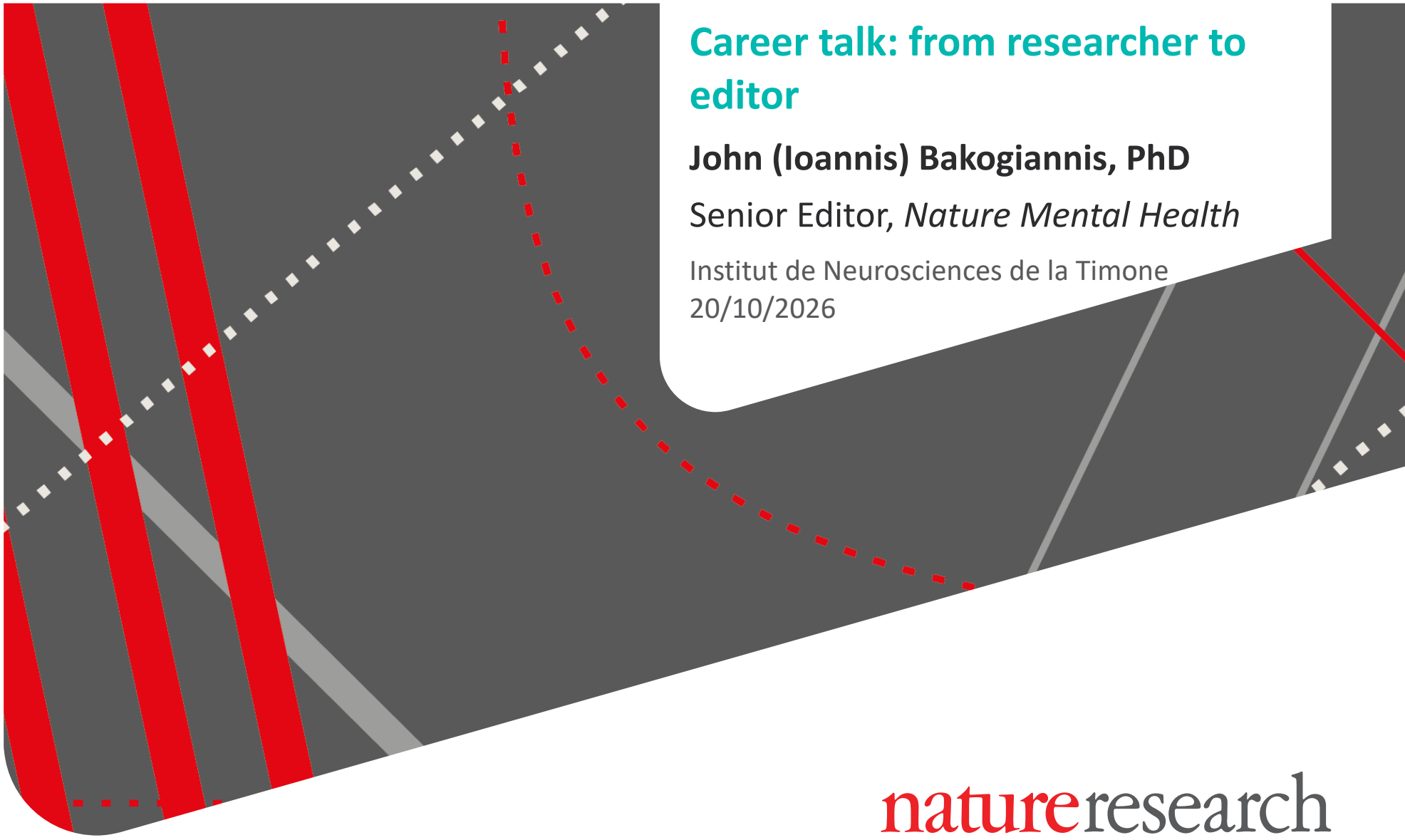


Illustration inspired by the work of Dorothy Hodgkin

Career talk: from researcher to editor

John (Ioannis) Bakogiannis, PhD

Senior Editor, *Nature Mental Health*

Institut de Neurosciences de la Timone

20/10/2026

nature research

A brief history of the Nature Portfolio



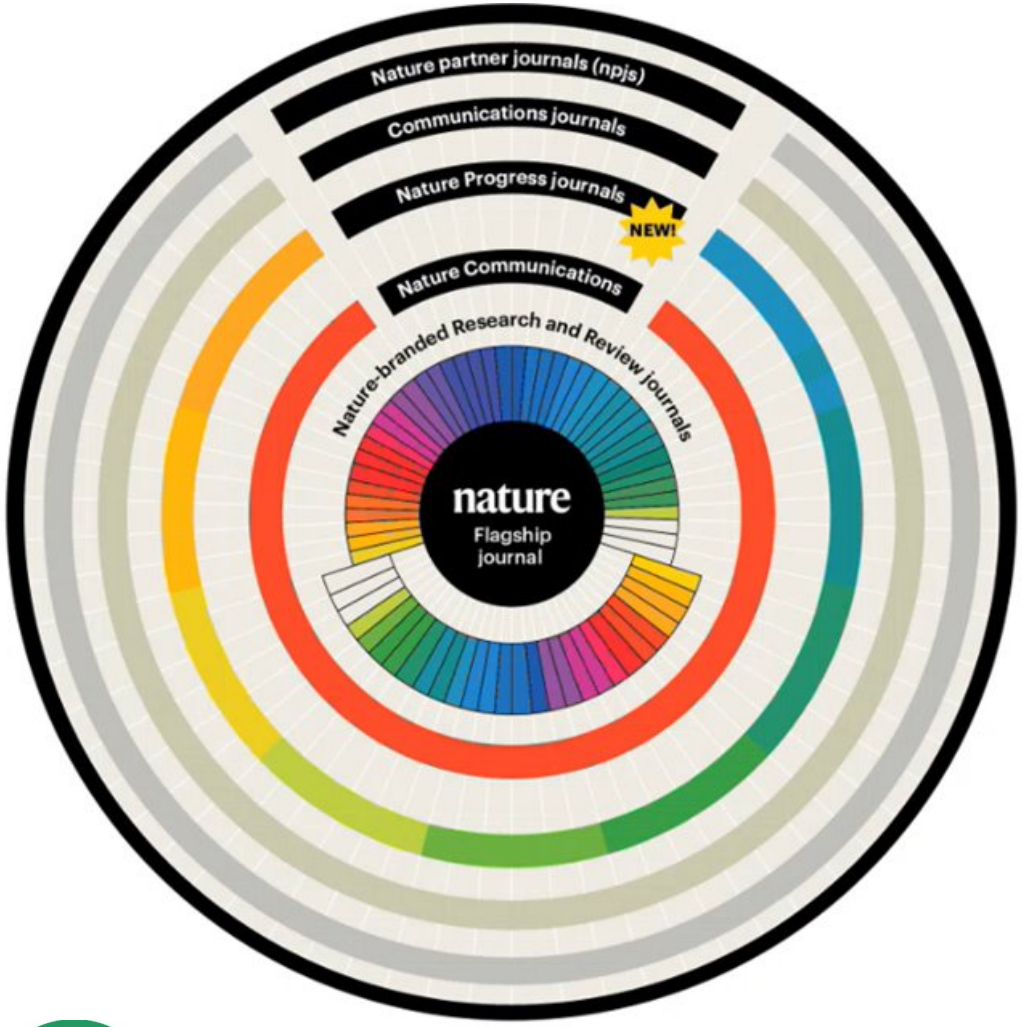
nature portfolio

Nature Portfolio is here to serve the research community by publishing its most significant discoveries—findings that advance knowledge and address some of the greatest challenges that we face as a society today. Our journals publish not only primary research but also reviews, critical comments, news and analyses.

Ultimately, if your work is scientifically robust, there is a home for your research within our family of journals. https://www.nature.com/siteindex

nature mental health

The Nature Portfolio



Widest importance and implications.
Significance should be obvious to any scientist working in any field of research.

Most relevant advances in a field.
Significance should be apparent to anyone in that discipline.

Highly significant advances that influence a field.
Broad appeal isn't a prerequisite for publication, great science is.

Important insights into focused areas of research.
New open access options reporting high-quality findings.

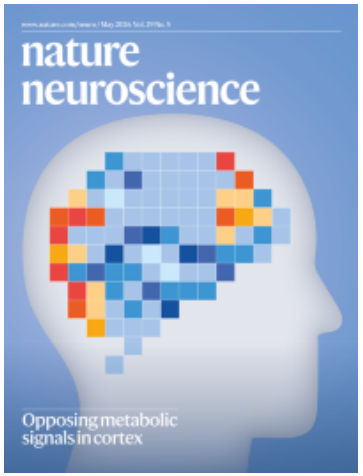
Technically sound, quality science.
Novelty is less important than sound science.

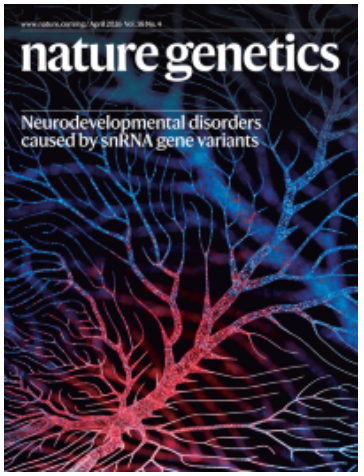
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Nature Research Journals

- >40 titles across the life, physical and social sciences
- No scientific editorial board
- Professional editors
- **Editorially independent of each other**

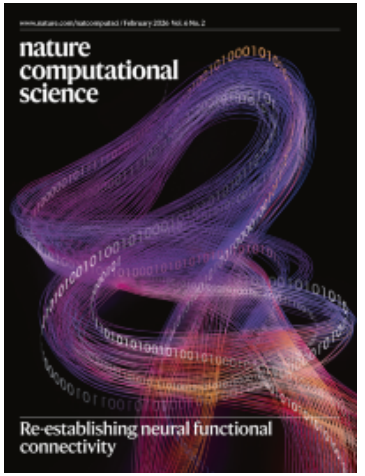












nature mental health

nature research

Nature Mental Health

2025



Scope: all areas of mental health and mental disorders

Major content types:

- **Articles:** 6 main display items
- **Analyses:** up to 8 display items
- **Reviews and Perspectives**
- **Commissioned 'Front half': News & Views, Comments, Correspondences, Q&As**
- **Editorials & Research Highlights**

2026



Aims and Scope

-Mental health is a human right and essential to an individual's well-being.

-Expansive view of the relationship between mental health and human health

-Committed to promoting scholarly research, increasing discourse and reinforcing connections among the members of the mental health community around the world.

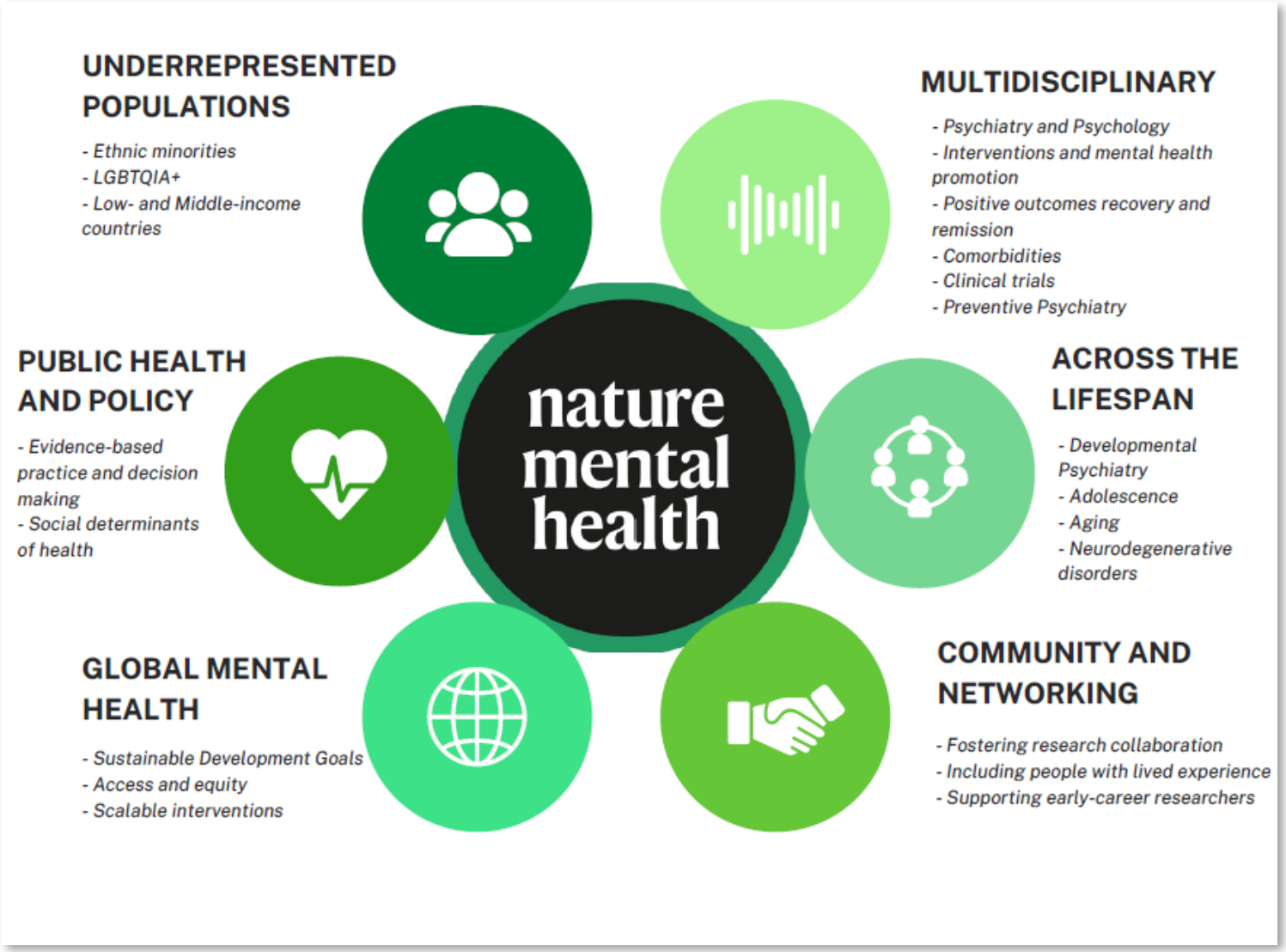
-Core mission of advancing racial, ethnic, gender, social, and global equity.

-Disciplines covered by Nature Mental Health include, but are not limited to:

- Addiction medicine
- Child and adolescent psychiatry
- Cross-cultural psychology
- Depression
- Eating disorders
- Emergency psychiatry
- LGBTQIA+
- Neurodevelopmental disorders
- Pain
- Suicide
- Violence

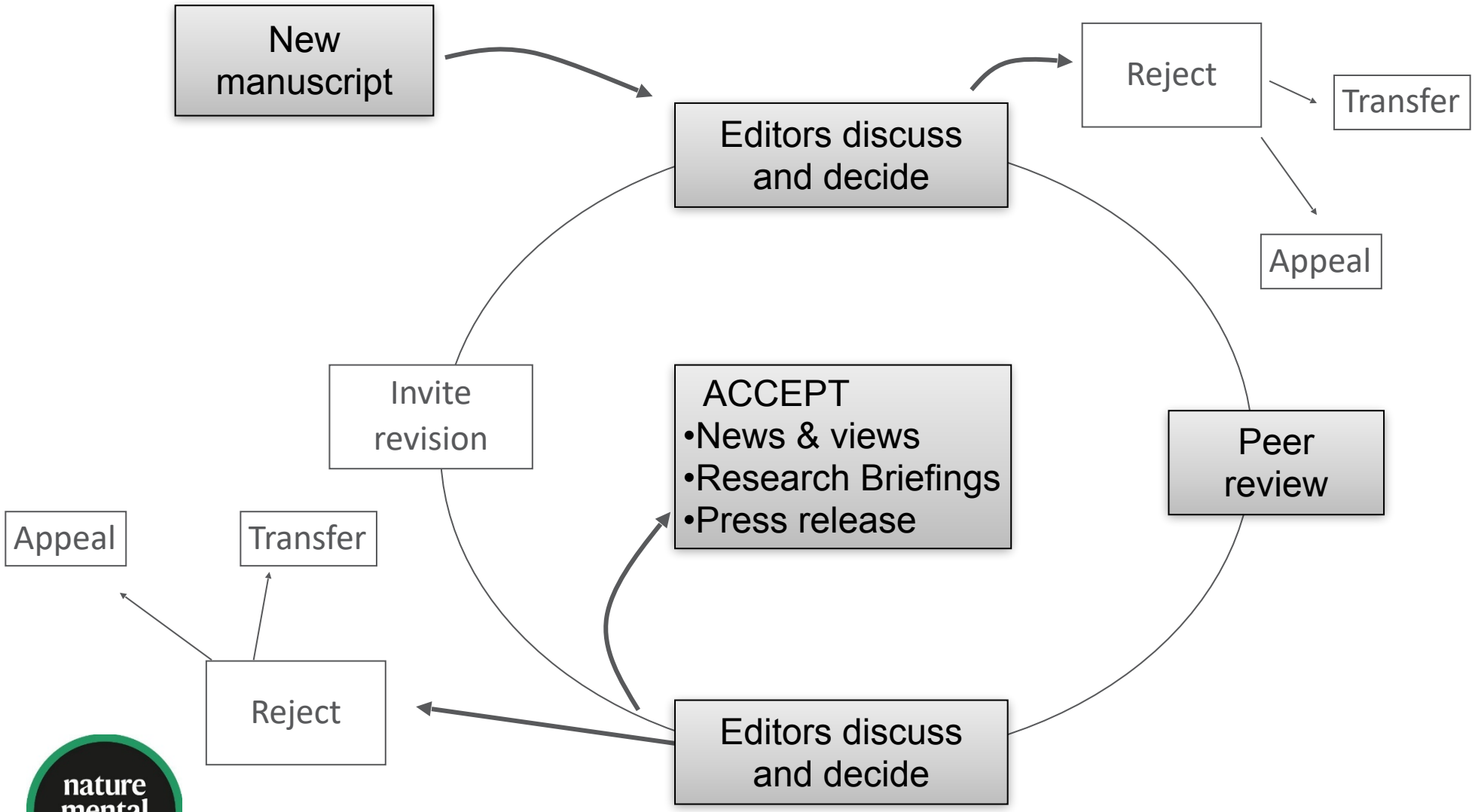


Topics covered

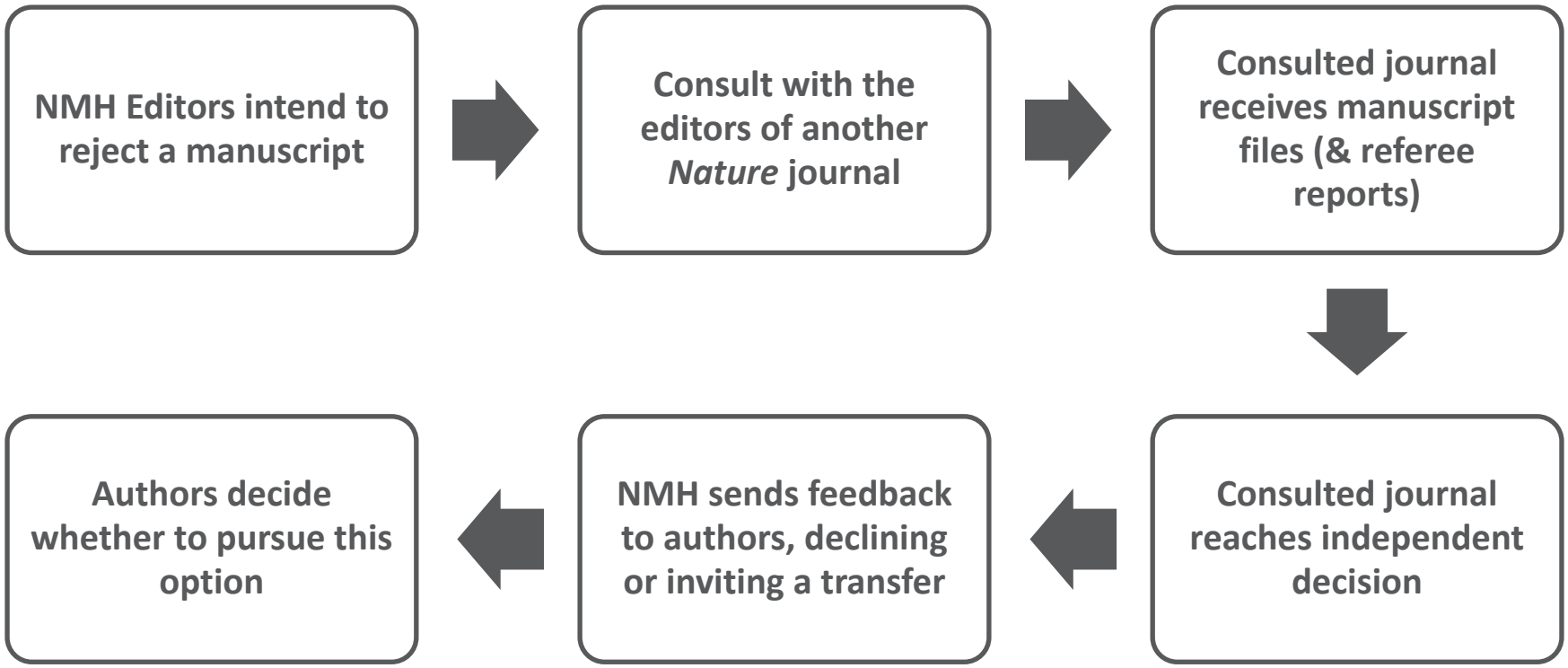


What is the editorial process?

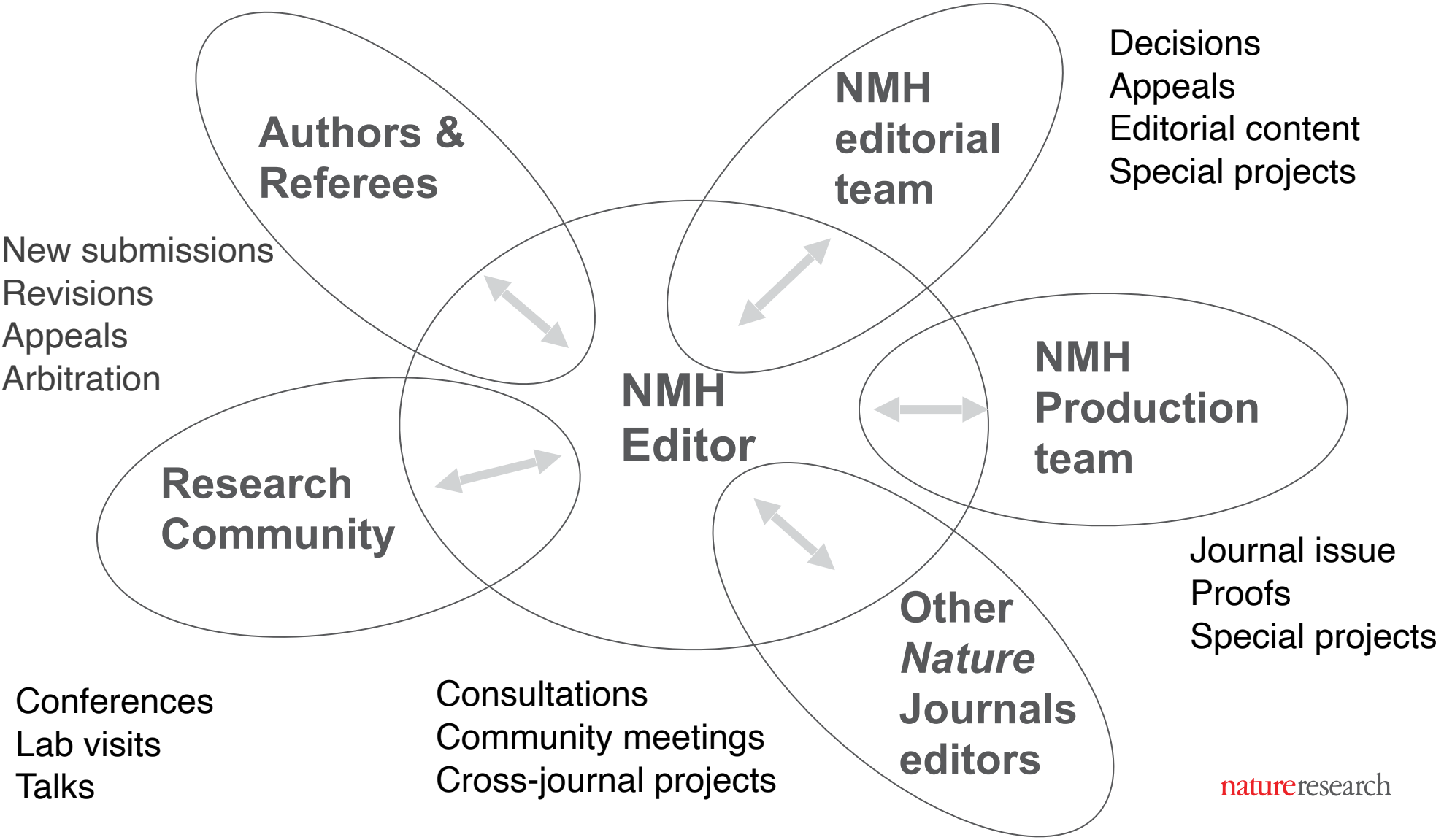
The life-cycle of a manuscript



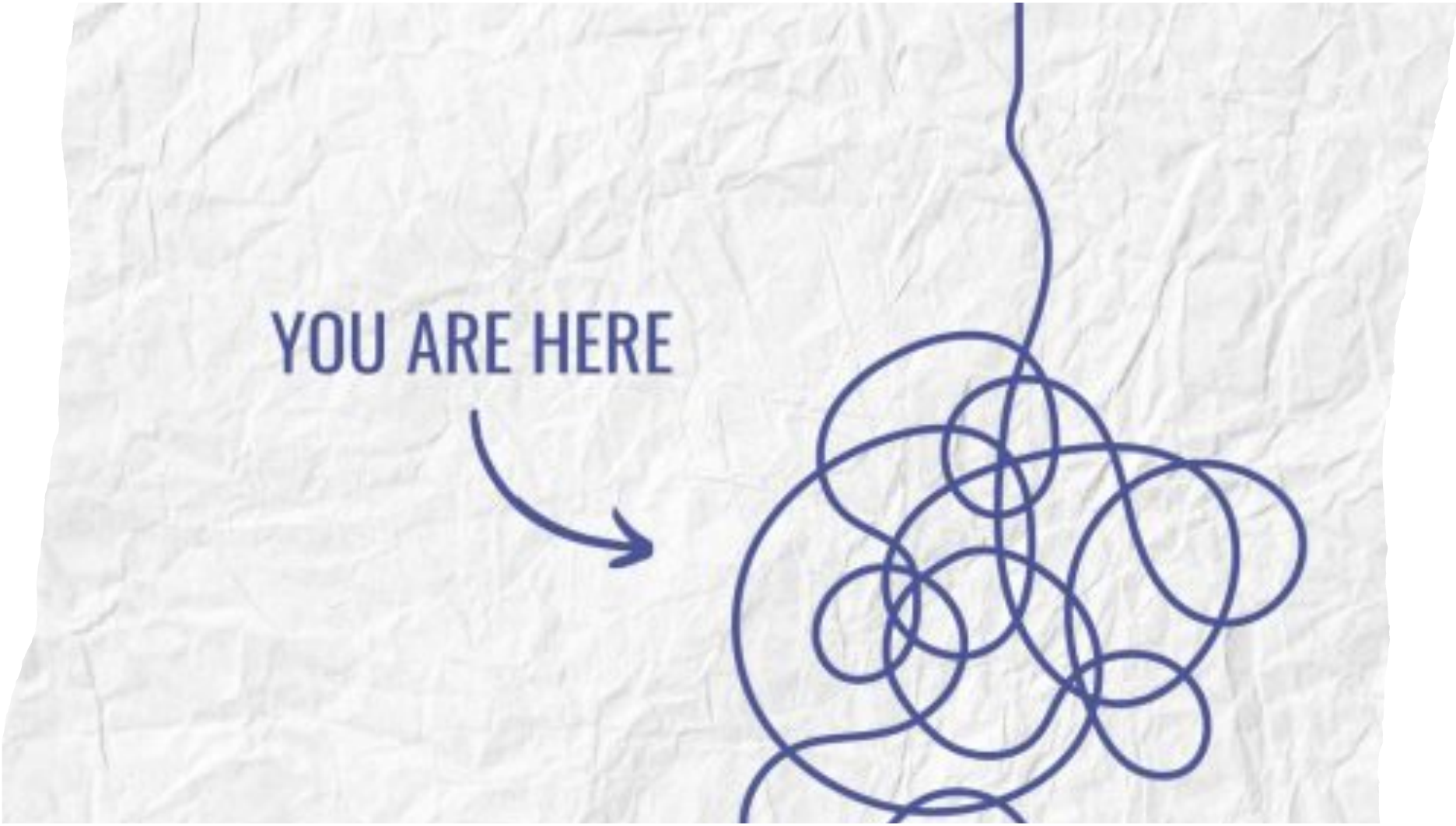
Manuscript consultations between *Nature* journals



A day in the life of an *NMH* editor



A day in the life of an *NMH* editor



On a typical day, an NMH editor would:

Assess new submissions, revisions, incoming referee reports, appeals, make and send decisions, look for referees.

Comment on manuscripts of other editors, participate in Editorial meetings.

Commission Reviews, Perspectives, Commentaries, handle their peer-review process, developmentally edit prior to publication.

Process manuscripts for formal acceptance, check final proofs for publication.

Write Editorials and Press Releases, commission and edit News & Views pieces.

Work on special projects (Focus issues, Article Series, Conferences etc.)
Communicate with authors and referees throughout these processes.

https://www.youtube.com/shorts/n0CXwr7GRe8

What makes a good editor?

- Strong commitment to science
- Broad knowledge on a variety of research areas
- Passion for learning
- Ability to think critically, deeply and clearly
- Integrity
- Confident in forming and defending a judgement, but not stubborn, can be persuaded by a valid argument
- Dynamic, outgoing, able to engage with other scientists
- Team-player
- Excellent organizational skills
- Excellent communication and writing skills
- Sense of responsibility towards the journal and the research communities it serves



NeuroPath: Exploring careers beyond academia

Ioannis Bakogiannis, Senior Editor at *Nature Mental Health*

Juan Garcia-Ruiz[1]
[1]Neurocentre Magendie, INSERM

The world of science offers many exciting paths, and academia is just one of them. Each year, both the public and private sectors actively seek PhD graduates to fill diverse roles. However, many of them may seem unfamiliar to most of us. At Brainstorm, we want to help you explore career options that align with your interests, and aspirations.

That's why we created NeuroPath: a section dedicated to highlight scientific related careers outside academia. We reached out to professionals, who like us, have earned a PhD in neurosciences, most of them from the Neurocampus, but chose to apply their expertise in different fields. Through their stories, they share insights into their career journeys, their current positions as well other practical questions.

Science is a lifelong pursuit, but the path you take is yours to choose.

Follow the one that excited you the most!

This month in Neuropath, we speak with **Ioannis Bakogiannis**, Senior Editor at Nature Mental Health, part of the Nature Portfolio. Ioannis brings more than three years of experience in scientific publishing and almost four years working across Nature Portfolio journals. With a background of over a decade in Neuroscience, Mental Health, and the Life Sciences, he describes himself as a goal-driven scientist who thrives in dynamic, collaborative environments. He earned his PhD in Bordeaux, where he investigated how diet-induced obesity affects memory and hippocampal connectivity under the supervision of Guillaume Ferreira at the NutriNeuro Lab (INRAE). Since January 2024, Ioannis has also been co-chair of the SN Pride Network at Springer Nature Group.

Are you interested in knowing more about the clinical research associate job as a career path? Then this section is for you!

Senior Editor at Nature Mental Health

Ioannis Bakogiannis



What is your role about?

I am a scientific in-house editor, responsible for the assessment and peer review process within the journal *Nature Mental Health*. My daily tasks include reading papers across a wide range of fields under the general umbrella of mental health, evaluating submissions, identifying reviewers when sending papers out for peer review, and making editorial decisions, which can often be challenging. I also attend conferences and symposia to stay informed about current research and participate in content commissioning for opinion pieces (Comments, News & Views, Perspectives, etc.). Additionally, editors write Q&As in the form of interviews and Research Highlights, which aim to showcase research published elsewhere. Some of these tasks may vary depending on the journal.

What made you choose this professional path?

After completing my PhD, I felt experimentally saturated. I wanted to remain in research while broadening my knowledge of other fields, exploring new techniques and projects, and engaging more in conceptual tasks and scientific writing. During my PhD, I attended a talk by a Nature Neuroscience editor at FENS, where she spoke specifically about her editorial career. She inspired me to follow this path and, in the end, we became colleagues. Therefore, thank you, Leonie!

What's a matching profile?

For an editorial role, a PhD in a relevant field to the journal is required, as well as a passion for science, critical thinking, an eye for detail, the ability to read and evaluate the strengths and weaknesses of papers and great communication skills. In most positions, a post-doctoral position is not required but is welcomed.

Do you have some advice for people interested in following this path?

Read papers (especially in bioRxiv or medRxiv), try to evaluate them from an editorial perspective (would you publish this paper and why?) and keep an eye out for opportunities on Springer Nature's job portal and follow journals on LinkedIn or other social media.

Main responsibilities

- Handling original research papers and working closely with editorial teams on all aspects of the editorial process, including manuscript selection and overseeing peer review.
- Making well-reasoned editorial decisions on submitted manuscripts in the light of expert advice.
- Commissioning and editing content such as Reviews and opinion pieces (varies by journal).
- Be eager to travel and represent the journal in Conferences and Symposia.
- Meet tight deadlines for different content types.
- Work together with other editors and departments, such as Art Editors, Editorial Assistants, and Production.

Requirements

A PhD in a relevant field and the characteristics I mentioned above.

Working conditions

- Work environment: Working with other editors and being tightly linked to researchers and current trends in science.
- Pressure level: High-paced because of meeting strict editorial deadlines.
- Work-life balance: Good work-life balance with the possibility of hybrid working conditions.
- Salary (interval): Varies per location (there is no location in France, but there are offices in Europe, including Berlin, London, Madrid and Milan).

Do you have further questions?

Contact Ioannis at ioannis.bakogiannis@nature.com

nature research